Unami Lodge, One LEC November Meeting Minutes
19, December, 2023
Cradle of Liberty Council #525
Reading the Vote final numbers: Yay/Nay/Abstain/No vote

Opening

Attendance: Craig Cless, Skye Kramer, John Bickel, Paul Bowman, C. Brett Montich, Matt Rouleau, Griffen O'Brien, Noah Goldberg, Robert Raggi, Zach Gilinger, Michael Gilinger, Jaclyn Keyser, Todge Sutkowski, Steve Mach, Michael Kawczynski Jr., Andrew Barnett, Rhys Wallace, Brian Darcas, Marina Darcas, Cynthia Darcas, Colin Darcas, Glenn Campbell, Andrew Smallberger, Larry Arinsberg, Aidan Sutkowski, Star McMackin, Nathan Schooler, Zach Kline, Liam Lynch, Michaela Donnelly, Brayden Liebel, Jack Ashton, Matt Horan, Luke Smallberger, Jason Abiuso, Mara Strauss, Martin Stacey, Michael Evans, Dr. David H. Sirken, Gregg Slocum, Katherine Schaffer, Phil Hittner, Paul Dallatore, Andrew Yankowski, Matthew Yankowski, Robert Raggi Jr., Paul Siminuk, William Beardsley

Motion: Liam Lynch- I would like to make a motion to approve last month's meeting minutes.
Seconded by: Andrew Smallberger PASSED

Committee Reports:

- AIA (Leah Callahan)
  - Drum is good 👍
- Brotherhood (Luke Smallberger)
  - The Brotherhood Committee enjoyed a successful and busy 2023 lodge year. We began with spring service 1, where we Sealed the Bonds of over 60 brothers. That weekend, along with the next four weekends, including the new Summer Induction and revived Brotherhood Blitz, resulted in our first year since 2019 with over 100 bonds sealed. The Brotherhood Committee thanks everyone in the lodge for support and hopes for an even more successful 2024.
- Camp Promotions (Anton Meyer)
  - No Report Submitted
- Ceremonies (Noah Goldberg)
  - Overall, ceremonies went swimmingly this year! I am very proud of everyone that has helped out with ceremonies, and even more thankful for them. During the dinner, everyone that helped out will be recognized, but for now I just want to say thank you to all of those who helped in any aspect. I can't wait for what we can do next year! If you are interested in any aspect of helping out with ceremonies, or you know someone who is, please let the ceremonies committee know. We had a few incredible ceremonialists retire this year, and are always looking for people to fill those spots. Thank you, and as a committee, we hope you enjoyed the ceremonies this year.
- Communications (Zach Gilinger)
  - Thank you to everyone who helped out with comms this year, we hope you continue to help next year. If any chapters have new information regarding

meeting dates and times please contact comms. If any chapters haven't sent in their election results please send us the updated list.

- Conclave (Emmie Menna)
    - No Report Submitted
- Events (Mara Strauss)
    - The event's committee has had several successes this year with the addition of a new induction based event, and exciting themes! These successes would not have been possible without the help of the large youth presence on the events committee, we truly worked together for the good of our Lodge's events. Our theme this year was elements, and although it rained most weekends we really made the best of it and the program was still exciting. We had exciting program elements like a bouncy house, hot air balloon, archery, a planetarium, fishing, bouldering, outdoor education, pilot info sessions, and more! It is our hope that our events only strive to get better in the future, and with youth involvement and LEC and general member feedback we can achieve that! Thank you for your continued support to the events committee, and sign up for the dinner!
- History (Aidan Sutkowski)
    - Pop-up displays at:
        - Lodge dinner
        - Continental Klondike
        - Lafayette Klondike
        - University of Scouting
        - Council dinner
        - Spring Service 1
        - Eagle Scout Dinner
        - Spring Service 2
        - SCOPE 2023
        - Resica Falls summer camp (all weeks)
        - Fall Fellowship
        - All Fall Fests (4)
        - New members bash
    - Two Booklets published
        - A History of Jewish Scouting in the Cradle of Liberty Council
        - A History of Catholic Scouting in the Archdiocese of Philadelphia
    - Three history hikes:
        - Troop 284 hike around Delmont
        - Crew 5 of the 2023 COL Philmont Contingent, hike around Hart and Delmont
        - Service Area 1 Cuboree hike around Hart
    - Year of Throwback Thursday posts
    - Yard sales at:
        - Spring Service 1
        - Spring Service 2

        - Fall Fellowship
        - Lodge dinner
    - Held the 2023 Memorabilia show which made $735.70 in profit
    - Released 15 episodes of “The Cedar Log”
        - NOAC interviews series
        - Scouting and Faith interview series
        - Treasure Island series
        - Surpassed 2,600 listens of the podcast
    - Reached over 580 followers on Instagram
    - Reached 820 likes on Facebook with over 860 followers on Facebook
    - Unami Lodge History Facebook Group reached over 600 members
    - Helped the communications committee secure a new digital camera
- LLD (Matt Rouleau)
    - Throughout the year, the LLD committee has worked diligently to put on the wonderful training event we did. In doing so, we hope we prepared everyone for the upcoming year as many important topics were covered and many new connections were made. Due to the responses on the Google form, we might be making some changes to the format of the event as well as holding additional sessions when needed. We thank all who came and are looking forward to next year!
- Lodge Operations (Martin Stacey)
    - Maintained and updated the R&P, as well as released some changes as of 4/25
    - Held a successful Awards and Recognitions meeting
    - Successfully elected the 2024 Lodge Officers
- Membership (Katherine Schaffer)
    - This year, the membership committee hosted a new members bash at the gravity vault rock gym, where new brothers participated in rock climbing and fellowship while getting to know more about our lodge, with 24 brothers in attendance. The membership committee also continued to keep track of member records in lodge master and at lodge weekends. A big thank you to all the adults and everyone that worked with the committee this year!
    - For the 2023 lodge year, Unami Lodge, One has a total of 1037 dues paying members.
    - In attendance at Spring Service 1 there were 263 members,
    - Spring Service 2 there were 173 members,
    - Summer Inductions there were 59 members,
    - And Fall Fellowship there were 260 members.
- NOAC (Will Beardsley)
    - NOAC registration closes Jan 31st
    - NOAC fundraising is going well and in case you didn’t hear, our Fall Fellowship patch auction took in twice what was anticipated!
    - Keep an eye out for a spring merit badge college… be sure to tell your district, unit, etc, and if you have an interest in teaching a badge, reach out to us

- Just in time for the holidays… quarter zips (as a NOAC fundraiser)! Mens and womens cuts! Look for a google form soon. Selling for $30 closing Jan 31st
- Ordeal (Tristan Hunter)
  - This year the ordeal committee experienced 262 new brothers inducted into our order this year, which is an increase of 60 over 2022's numbers. We hope to continue to have this number grow and to retain these newly inducted brothers going through the new year.
- Service (Dan McDougald)
  - No Report Submitted
- Unit Elections (Nathan Schooler)
  - This year has been pretty good for the unit elections committee. In the beginning of the year the committee had a Guide Unit Elections training that was held online. I would like to congratulate all of the chapters on completing 100% of their unit elections!!
- Unit Representative (Chris Hartley)
  - No Report Submitted
- Vigil Honor (Patrick Lynch)
  - As far as a report goes for the committee. Probably just say how we inducted 16 vigil honor members this year, and have started to produce fundraising properties to support the committee.
  - Vigil fundraiser chenille patches are available for sale on the lodge trading post website and while the trading post is open.
  - Vigil nominations are open. Please go to Unamilodge.org. The nominations are submitted under the awards section of the website. The deadline is March 31st. Each chapter will be required to send one representative to the Vigil elections.
  - The Vigil Committee's Camp Delmont- Thunderbird rock patch was ordered this week. Keep an eye out for sale dates.

Chapter Reports:

- Baden Powell (Johnny Marcus) [Y:A:]
  - No Report Submitted
- Conestoga (Dominic Tomesetti) [Y:A:]
  - No Report Submitted
- Constellation (Aidan Sutkowski) [Y:0A:2]
  - No Report Submitted
- Continental (Will Gabel) [Y:A:]
  - No report submitted
- General Nash (Brayden Leibel) [Y:8A:2]
  - No Report Submitted
- Lafayette (Colin Darcas) [Y:6A:6]
  - 12 Elections / 8 Visits 100% completions
  - Ordeal Elected: 44

    - Ordeal Completed: 47 107%
    - Brotherhood Eligible: 50
    - Brotherhood Completed: 27 54%
    - Lafayette District Klondike Derby, Oregon Trail was planned and ran by Lafayette Chapter members January 2023
    - Lafayette Chapter Dutch Oven Bake Off at District picnic June 2023
    - Lafayette District Fall Camporee planned and ran by Lafayette Chapter members October 2023
- Minquas (Peter Valtos) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Northern (Miko Kaka) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Roosevelt (Martin Stacey) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Triune (Emmie Menna) [Y:A:]
    - No Report Submitted
- Washington (Star McMackin) [Y:8A:8]
    - No Report Submitted

Reports

OASE (Paul Siminuk)

I had the opportunity to travel to the Summit Bechtel Reserve, for Order of the Arrow Summit Experience, using a lodge campership. It's one of the opportunities that every arrowmen should attend. I left June 26th. Something that is very unique is that it is the first only co-ed high adventure experience. Alongside this is service and fun and fellowship and high adventure. During the first 5 days of our trek we were out in the New River Gorge National Forest making a new hiking trail. Trail quality is extremely important because you are building this trail to the national park standards. Park rangers kept coming all week telling us what we needed to raise or fix. Once we got in the fellowship part of the week, we had 2 and a half days of high adventure on base. We got to do the big zip, the rocks (rock wall) ranging from simple to vertical climbs and also had the leap of faith. Alongside that we were also able to experience whitewater rafting, something summit crews typically can't do unless you do the whitewater rafting trek. The water was extremely rough because it poured. Our boat was under the water, swimming on top hoping the boat would come up. Highly recommend it to anyone. Anyone between the ages of 14-18, I highly recommend taking advantage of this opportunity.

PMP Report

This year the lodge reached 19 points. Meaning we are a THRIVING lodge this year. We did 50% of brotherhood conversion, last year it was 20%. 78% unit elections rate, lodge event participation is 19%. The lodge is almost 50/50 youth v adult. In the past it used to be mainly adult. The youth are coming back so keep it up! We didn't exceed members this year, but we didn't lose any youth, only lost adults.

Business

NOAC Gear (Will Beardsley)
We are looking to seek approval to use a logo. To put together a new quarter zip for the lec. We are seeking approval for the design, not the object.

Will Beardsley - I would like to make a motion to approve the usage of that logo. Seconded by: Griffen O'Brien PASSED

Anything for the good of the Lodge:

Mara Strauss: Sign up for lodge dinner, registration closes at the end of 2023, it's going to be out of this world. The food is going to be delicious (I hope). $40 for youth, $45 for adults.

Steve Mach: As many of you know, Patrick and Liam are being deployed in the next couple weeks. So, we thought it was best for them to receive their awards.

Brett Montich: The vigil honor committee is very honored to present our vigil chenille to Patrick Lynch for honor to the vigil committee.

Steve Mach: The Charles J. "Chuck" Benshetler Spirit of Camp Leadership Award- honored to present to Patrick Lynch; many years at Resica from Native America Village to the pool and continues to go back and volunteer.

Craig Cless: Thank you for all the work you have done in the past year; it is for all of your dedication to the lodge over the year; Liam Lynch 2023.

Liam also got the founders award!!

Lodge Staff Advisor Minute: John Bickel
So, first of all, happy holidays. Thank you everyone for parking on the grass. Two things: we have 2 camps looking for camp staff. If you are looking for a local experience, camp staff at Musser. If you are looking for further experience, camp staff at Resica. Thanks for a great year, looks like a great year when it comes to the pmp statistics. We saw what we had to do better over the past year. Thanks to the chief, I thank you for the service you gave the lodge and now our country.

Lodge Adviser Minute: Craig Cless
A little different, I want to echo everything John said.
"There once was a little boy who had a very bad temper. His father decided to hand him a bag of nails and said that every time the boy lost his temper, he had to hammer a nail into the fence. On the first day, the boy hammered 37 nails into that fence.

The boy gradually began to control his temper over the next few weeks, and the number of nails he was hammering into the fence slowly decreased. He discovered it was easier to control his temper than to hammer those nails into the fence.
Finally, the day came when the boy didn't lose his temper at all. He told his father the news and the father suggested that the boy should now pull out a nail every day he kept his temper under control.
The days passed and the young boy was finally able to tell his father that all the nails were gone. The father took his son by the hand and led him to the fence.
'You have done well, my son, but look at the holes in the fence. The fence will never be the same. When you say things in anger, they leave a scar just like this one. You can put a knife in a man and draw it out. It won't matter how many times you say I'm sorry, the wound is still there.'"

I say this because we need to become united as Unami Lodge One, we have a lot of possibilities and promise statements. We needed 3 points to become a High Performing Lodge. So I want every committee to focus on that to become a high performing lodge next year.

Chief Minute: Liam Lynch
I am speaking to those who are going to be on the LEC next year.
I want to say thank you Unmai Lodge for the past 7 years of Fellowship, brotherhood, advisers, memories and friendships that I will never forget. However now it is time for me to pass the torch and let a new generation of youth take charge. Now I have learned lots and lots these past 7 years and I would like to share the hardest lesson I have learned with all of you.

"If you collect 100 black ants and 100 fire ants and put them in a glass jar, nothing will happen. But if you take the jar, shake it violently and leave it on the table, the ants will start attacking each other. Red believes that black is the enemy, while black believes that red is the enemy, when the real enemy is the person who shook the jar. The same is true for the lodge. Before we fight each other, we must ask ourselves: Who shook the jar?"

We get caught up in things that don't matter and people who love to stir the pot and cause problems. So I offer you this for your upcoming lodge year.

"You gotta let go of that stuff from the past, because it just doesn't matter! The only thing that matters is what you choose to do now." From an awesome movie: Kung Fu Panda

It's been an honor Unami, I challenge you all to continue to make this lodge a strong and united Unami. Thank You.

Closing and Song

Voting during the LEC

Quorum:
To make a motion- 60% of voting members must be present (17 of 28)
To pass a motion- 50% + 1 of present voting members must vote yay (15 for a full LEC)

Yay/Nay/Abstain/No vote
Y=Yay N=Nay A=Abstain -= No vote

Motions:
1: Approval of Last Month's Meeting Minutes: Liam Lynch- I would like to make a motion to approve last month's meeting minutes. Seconded by: Andrew Smallberger PASSED
2: Approval of NOAC Gear: Will Beardsley - I would like to make a motion to approve the usage of that logo. Seconded by: Griffen O'Brien PASSED

Committee/Chapter	**Vote**
Vice Chief 1	Y y
Vice Chief 2	Y y
Secretary	Y y
Treasurer	Y y
American Indian Affairs	
Brotherhood	Y y
Camp Promotions	
Ceremonies	Y y
Communications	Y y
Conclave	
Events	Y y
History	Y y
Lodge Leadership Development	Y y
Lodge Operations	Y y
Membership	Y y
NOAC	Y y

Ordeal	Y y
Service	Y y
Unit Elections	Y y
Unit Representative	
Vigil Honor	
Immediate Past Chief	Y y
Baden Powell	
Conestoga	
Constellation	
Continental	Y y
General Nash	Y y
Lafayette	Y y
Minquas	
Northern	
Roosevelt	
Triune	Y y
Washington	Y y

Lodge Chief (Only in the event of a tie)	